

and move forward when the time comes. By providing a clear action plan, “change management” helps minimize the risk of failure. The media giant Netflix is an example of a business transformed through careful change management. In 2007, after 10 years operating as a DVD rental service, the company moved to digital streaming in response to emerging technology. Netflix managed this change carefully from the outset, with clear communication to its whole workforce, ensuring a highly successful and lucrative transition.



MAKING IT WORK

Before introducing changes to your business, develop a plan that acknowledges the practical and emotional implications.

Practical action

- › **Schedule milestones** at which you can assess the impact of the change and spot potential problems.
- › **Review progress** weekly, and keep staff and all stakeholders informed.
- › **Remain calm** if change takes longer than expected. A longer wait with the support of employees might be more effective than rushed change.

Emotional awareness

- › **Thank your staff** through regular emails and informal meetings.
- › **Reinforce** the reasons for change regularly to remind your team why change will make working life better.
- › **Reward colleagues** for their service if the change involves letting anyone go, and help them find new jobs through networking or agencies.

“Where there
are changes,
there are
always business
opportunities.”

Minoru Makihara, Japanese
industrialist, 1996

COMMUNICATE AND ENGAGE

Explain clearly to staff and business associates why change is necessary, how it will affect them day-to-day, and how you will support them. Encourage feedback and answer any concerns.

IMPLEMENT AND EMBED

Introduce changes, following your formal plan. Make sure staff receive any new training or equipment they need. Encourage and motivate staff, giving them recognition for each step of the change achieved.

MONITOR

Set a good example as an engaged and decisive leader of the business and learn from any mistakes—made by you as well as staff. Continue to engage employees, not only during the change period but also in the long term.